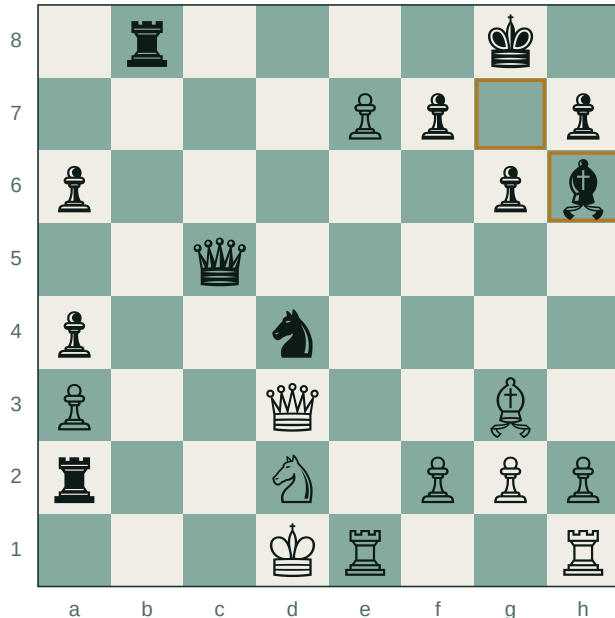


# Kingside attacks: White, move 28

Kingside attacks

White to move



Previous move: 27...Bh6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**28. e8=Q+ Rxe8 29. Rxe8+**

**28.e8=Q+** Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. The pawn becomes a queen. From e8 it attacks king on g8 and rook on b8. Recorded reply: **28...Rxe8**.

**29.Rxe8+** Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on e8.

At the end, nominal material is White 29 / Black 25 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

## CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from +0 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

## CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not count distant pieces as attackers unless they can reach useful squares in time. Every preparatory move gives the defender a turn.

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A kingside attack succeeds when pieces and pawn breaks create concrete threats near the king. The attack must arrive before the defender can exchange attackers or counter in the center.

## HOW TO LOOK

Count the pieces that can join immediately, identify an entry square, and calculate the defender's checks and exchanges.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on b8 and bishop on h6. Check for tactical protection.